THE SAFFRON STRONGHOLDS

In these states, the BJP still maintains an edge in a national contest

ARUNACHAL PRADESH
2 / 2 (58.9%)

ASSAM
14 / 9 (36.4%)

UTTARAKHAND
5 / 5 (61.7%)

DELHI
7 / 7 (56.9%)

GUJARAT
26 / 26 (63.1%)

GOA
2 / 1 (51.9%)

MANIPUR
2 / 1 (34.3%)

TRIPURA
2 / 2 (49.6%)

STATES WHERE BJP HAS NO FOOTPRINT

In 2019, the BJP could not open its account in these states

SIKKIM
1 / 0 (4.7%)

NAGALAND
1 / DNP (DNP)

MEGHALAYA
2 / 0 (8%)

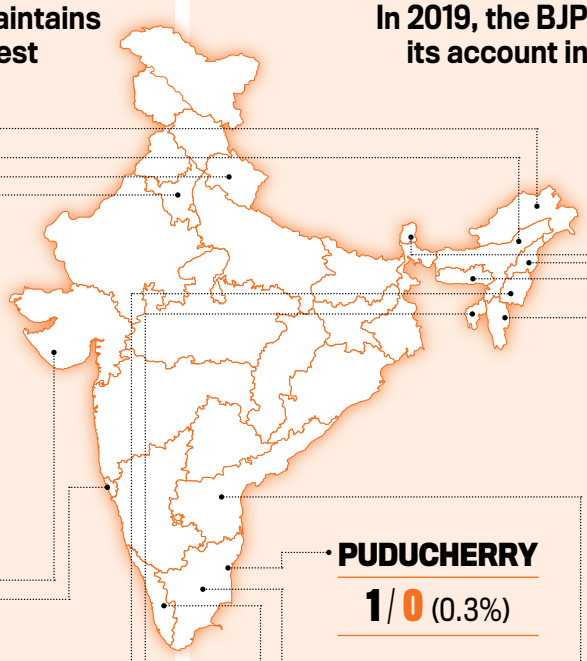
MIZORAM
1 / 0 (5.8%)

ANDHRA PRADESH
25 / 0 (1%)

PUDUCHERRY
1 / 0 (0.3%)

TAMIL NADU
39 / 0 (3.7%)

KERALA
20 / 0 (13%)



■ Total seats ■ BJP won in 2019 (Vote share in 2019)

has thwarted the BJP repeatedly, it has been targeting Abhishek Banerjee, her nephew and second in command of the Trinamool Congress (TMC). On June 8, the day the Election Commission of India announced the dates for the panchayat polls in Bengal, the Enforcement Directorate (ED) summoned Abhishek to Delhi to interrogate him on his alleged role in the teachers' recruitment scam (which the CBI is also probing). The ED has also questioned his wife Rujira in another case involving coal pilferage. But Mamata is a tough customer and the TMC's sweeping victory in the recent civic body polls indicates that her base remains strong while the BJP's stands much weakened. Indeed, the party may find it difficult to repeat its 2019 performance—18 of the 42 LS seats in the state—and will have to continue to rely on Modi if it is to pull it off.

THE SOUTHERN SWING

The other large Opposition state the BJP is targeting is Tamil Nadu which has 39 Lok Sabha seats and where the saffron party failed to open its account in the 2019 poll. The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) headed by chief minister M.K. Stalin under the banner of the Secular Progressive Alliance, which included the Congress and Communist parties, took 38 of the 39 seats. The DMK alone won 24 seats. The BJP's gameplan here is to discredit the DMK while forming an alliance with the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK) and its breakaway factions led by O. Panneerselvam and another steered by T.T.V. Dhinakaran. Last month, the ED launched a probe into the cash-for-jobs scam involving the DMK's electricity minister V. Senthil Balaji when he was transport minister in an earlier AIADMK government in 2014. Stalin, who has backed Balaji, pointed out that BJP leaders too have cases against them and that "the moral high ground cannot be a one-way street".

In Telangana, which has 17 Lok Sabha seats, the BJP is pushing to win more than the four seats it won in 2019. The ED is targeting Kalvakuntla Kavitha, daughter of chief minister K. Chandrashekar Rao (KCR), in a money laundering case linked to the Delhi excise scam. Modi has alleged that KCR, who heads the Bharat Rashtra Samithi (BRS) and has